Nudge PRD

Oct 25, 2026 · @Chitraksha Kashyap

Project	Nudge MVP
Creator	*Chitraksha Kashyap*
Overview	Nudge is a mobile-first app for shared bills, automatic reminders, and one-tap payback through your preferred payment app. Roommates log a bill once, split it however they want, and Nudge handles the follow-up so the person who paid never has to follow up.
Status	*Launched*

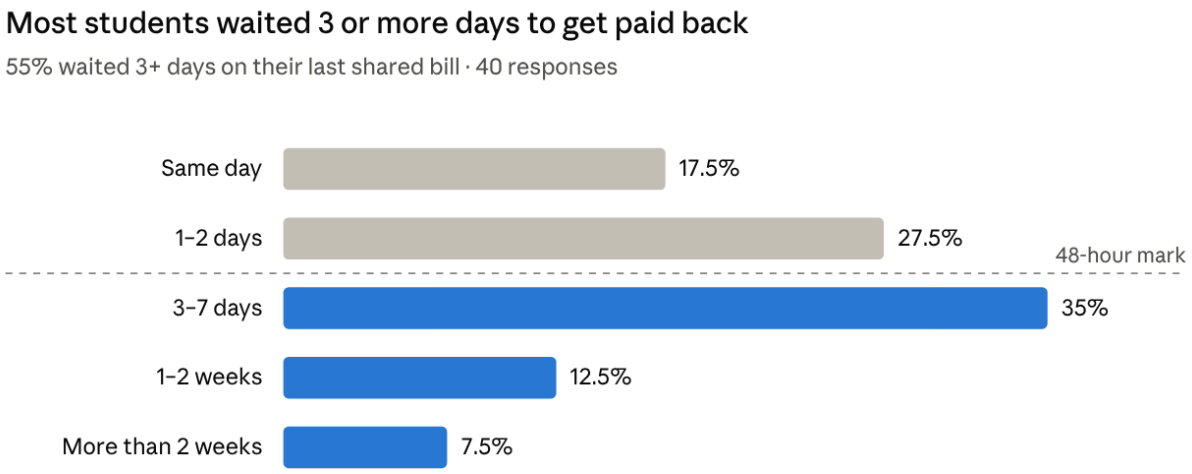
Problem

Students who pay shared household bills struggle with two things: keeping track of who has paid them back, and getting paid without repeatedly texting their roommates. Splitting the math is easy; tracking and following up are the hard parts.

In 30+ interviews with college students, almost everyone described the same pattern:

- One roommate pays the electric, gas, or internet bill because the account is in their name.
- Repayment often takes weeks, and sometimes it slips everyone's mind.
- With several bills and roommates, it's hard to keep track of who has paid what, since payments are scattered across different apps and texts.
- The person owed hates being the one who has to ask, so they delay the text, send it awkwardly, or absorb the cost.
- Nobody minds paying their share. The friction is in tracking payments and asking for them.

A survey of 41 college students backs this up: 55% waited 3 or more days to get paid back on their last shared bill, 68% had to remind someone at least once, and 37% had skipped asking for money in the past 3 months because it felt awkward.



Roommate survey of college students, November 2026 · 40 responses

Problem statement: When I pay a shared bill, I want to see at a glance who has paid me back and get paid without having to chase anyone, so I can stay fair without straining the relationship.

Why this matters and alternatives

Existing tools solve tracking and payment, but leave the asking to the person who paid. Nudge bets that automating the follow-up, not the math, is what gets people paid back.

Alternative	**What it does well**	**Where it falls short for this problem**
Group chat + payment app	Free, everyone already uses it	All tracking and reminding is manual
Venmo Groups	Shared expenses and settling inside Venmo	Built around one payment app; roommates who use Zelle or Cash App are left out
Splitwise	Detailed balance tracking across many groups	Follow-up still depends on the person owed; payment happens elsewhere

Nudge's differentiation:

1. Reminders are automatic and recurring, so the payer never has to ask.

2. It works with whichever payment app each roommate already uses. In the survey, 85% of students use Zelle and 82% use Venmo, so a tool built around one app leaves many roommates out.
3. It is focused on households, but can work with different group expenses.

Target users and user stories

The first users are college students sharing an apartment, with two roles that every household has.

Persona	Who they are	What they need
The bill payer	Has the utility or internet account in their name and fronts the cost each month	To get paid back without chasing anyone
The roommate who owes	Happy to pay their share but busy and forgetful	A clear, low-effort way to see what they owe and pay it

User stories

1. As a bill payer, I want to add a bill and split it among my roommates so everyone knows what they owe.
2. As a bill payer, I want to split a bill unevenly (by amount or percentage) when usage or room size differs.
3. As a bill payer, I want Nudge to remind my roommates automatically so I never have to text them.
4. As a roommate who owes, I want to see my balance at a glance so I know exactly what I owe.
5. As a roommate who owes, I want to pay in one tap with the app I already use.
6. As a bill payer, I want to confirm when I've been paid so balances stay accurate.

Goals & Success

We'll know Nudge is working when roommates pay each other back faster than they do today and the person who paid stops tracking balances in their head, without anyone muting reminders. Baselines come from a survey of 41 college students.

Metric	Baseline	Target	Why it matters
48-hour repayment rate	45%	Over 60% of	The core promise: getting paid back

		shares	without chasing anyone.
Median time to repayment	3–7 days	Under 72 hours	Shows Nudge beats the wait most students described.
Bills that needed a manual reminder	68%	Under 20%	The payer shouldn't have to ask; Nudge reminds for them.
Payers who check balances weekly	—	Over 50%	Shows Nudge replaces keeping track in your head.
Groups that add a second bill	—	Over 40%	The most telling early signal that people come back.
Reminder opt-out rate	—	Under 10%	Guardrail: 12% of students want only one reminder, so follow-ups can't overreach.

Solution and user flow

Nudge turns the follow-up into the app's job: bills go in once, reminders go out automatically, and payback is one tap away.

Step-by-step flow

1. The bill payer signs in with an email link and adds how roommates can pay them (Venmo username, Cash App $cashtag, or Zelle email/phone).
2. They create a household and share the invite link; roommates join and add their own payment handles.
3. The bill payer adds a bill (for example, $90 internet), chooses who paid, and splits it equally, by amount, or by percentage. Nudge checks the shares add up to the total.
4. Nudge emails each roommate their share with a link to pay.
5. A roommate opens the pay screen, picks a payment app, and pays. Venmo and Cash App open prefilled; Zelle shows the handle to copy.
6. The roommate returns and taps "I've paid."
7. The bill payer confirms the payment, and balances update.
8. If a share is still unpaid after 2 days, Nudge sends a follow-up reminder, and repeats every 2 days until it's paid.

Screens: sign in, payment methods, household setup, home (balance card and activity feed), new bill, pay a roommate, and bill detail. Mockups and the build spec are kept in the project folder.

Requirements

Here's what the MVP needs to include, what comes next, and what we're deliberately leaving out for now.

P0, must have

- **Groups:** start a group with roommates or friends.
- **Add and split bills:** split equally, by amount, or by percentage.
- **Balances:** see who owes you and who you owe at a glance.
- **Mark as paid:** settle a share so balances stay accurate.
- **Demo mode:** try it with sample friends and bills, no account needed.
- **Automatic reminders:** email roommates when a bill is added and every 2 days while unpaid.

P1, nice to have

- **Accounts and invite links:** sign in so groups and bills are saved across devices.
- **One-tap payback:** pay through Venmo, Cash App, or Zelle.

Not in v1

- Moving money or verifying payments, recurring bills, receipt scanning, and native iOS or Android apps.

Risks

The biggest risk is that reminders feel naggy enough that roommates mute them, which would break the core promise.

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Reminders annoy roommates	Users mute or leave; repayment doesn't improve	Track opt-out rate as a guardrail; tune cadence; add friendly copy
Payments can't be verified	Balances drift if people forget to tap "I've paid"	Payer confirms each payment; prompt after returning from a payment app
Venmo link format changes	Pay button breaks	Fall back to opening the recipient's profile
Low adoption across a	App only works if all roommates	Make joining one tap from the

household	join	invite link; no app download required
Emails land in spam	Reminders never seen	Use a verified sending domain; test with student email accounts

Open Issues & Key Decisions

A few things are still being worked through; this keeps a record of the tradeoffs as they're settled.

Issue / Decision	Status	Notes
What should the default reminder cadence be?	Decided	Every 2 days, since 51% of surveyed students prefer every 2–3 days.
Should the payer be able to change the cadence?	Open	22% of students prefer daily and 12% want only one reminder, so one setting may not fit everyone.
Should roommates be able to dispute a bill or their share?	Open	Weighing fairness against the extra complexity in v1.
Email, text, or push for reminders?	Open	Email is cheapest to build first; texts may get faster responses.
Keep Cash App or swap in Apple Cash?	Open	Only 3% of surveyed students use Cash App, while 13% use Apple Cash.

Launch Readiness

Key Milestones

The rollout moves from internal testing to a small pilot, to a public launch timed with spring move-ins.

Date	Milestone	Audience	Description
Oct–Nov 2026	Development	Internal only	Surveyed 41 students, interviewed 30+, and built the MVP.
Nov - Dec, 2026	Beta	5–10 Northeastern households	A 2-week pilot measuring repayment speed and reminder opt-outs.
TBD	Launch	Northeastern students, then any roommates	Public launch at the start of spring semester, when new leases and sublets begin.

Launch Checklist

Each item needs an answer before Nudge goes public.
TBD